

China Bans Internet Cafés

The Chinese government has issued a notice that directs local governments to "not sanction the opening of new Internet bars." This is just another example of governmental control over what people see online. But they're still optimistic of having more people online than the US in the next two years.



Adobe Launches Apollo

The alpha version of Adobe Apollo was released in March 2007. Apollo is a cross-platform runtime environment, much like Flash player, that will allow Web developers and Flash programmers to start developing Flash, Flex, AJAX, JavaScript and HTML applications for the Desktop.



Enter

Sanjay Gadhvi

Director

Gadhvi made his debut as a director with the movie *Tere Liye* in 2000, and came under the spotlight with *Dhoom* and *Dhoom 2*.

Technology...

...helps me convey my story to the audience. It is a medium through which thoughts can be exchanged. A director who resists the use of technology is making the worst mistake.

What gadgets do you use?

I have a Mac laptop, and I use software for editing, scheduling, screenplay, pre production, story-boarding... I also have a digicam and handycam, which I use a lot.

Your dream gadget?

I wish there were a combination of hardware and software through which I could do away with actors after taking 3D images of them and later recreate them virtually along with their voice...

What do you mostly do online?

I check my Gmail... we exchange loads of photos and data through mail.

Any instance where technology has really helped you?

Technology has helped me a lot with editing. It has simplified processes, and also drastically reduced the time. When we created *Dhoom 2*, we had pre-visualised stunts, thus allowing us to take the shots the way we wanted them.

ADDICTED

Indians And Chinese Addicted To Net

China and India... one-third of the entire Earth's population... and soon, the majority of the online population as well...

An increasing number of Chinese and Indian youth are getting online, and most educated teenagers have already used the Internet. However, it's been said that the Net is like a drug, and apparently, it is.

In March 2007, there was a lot of serious discussion about the addictiveness of the Net, and its influence on the young, in both China and India. Not all of it was talk, however, and two instances of actual steps being taken to prevent or control Net-addiction also made headlines.

The Chinese have been battling this problem for some time now, what with their Internet-savvy populace growing by the minute—much like our population. They do things differently there, and even their version of Netaholics Anonymous (there's no such thing, we made up that name) is like a military boot camp. Actually it is a military boot camp, complete with an army colonel, drill sergeants, calisthenics...the works!

The Chinese government has already reported that the amount of Internet users grew by almost 24 per cent from 2005 to 137 million, and this meant that the

are, and though they've only tried to "rehabilitate" 1,500 patients since 2004, the IATC claim to have a 70 per cent success rate. "Hmm, 2 million by 1500 into 2 years..." is what most of you are probably

thinking, but this is China we're talking about... for all we know, in our April 2008 issue we might be reporting that there are 4,000 IATC branches across China!

Anyway, enough about Chinese boot camps for now, let's get back to what's happening in India:

IIT Bombay has decided to limit and monitor the Net connections they

provide to students living in the hostels. Thus far, access was pretty unrestricted and unmonitored, and as a result, a few students' grades have suffered, are late for morning classes due to all-night online gaming, chatting or surfing, and a very marked reduction in human-human interaction.

Prakash Gopalan, Dean, Student Affairs, is of the opinion that it's not healthy that a student doesn't know who his neighbours in the hostel are, or miss the camaraderie and socialising that used to be part of hostel life. With

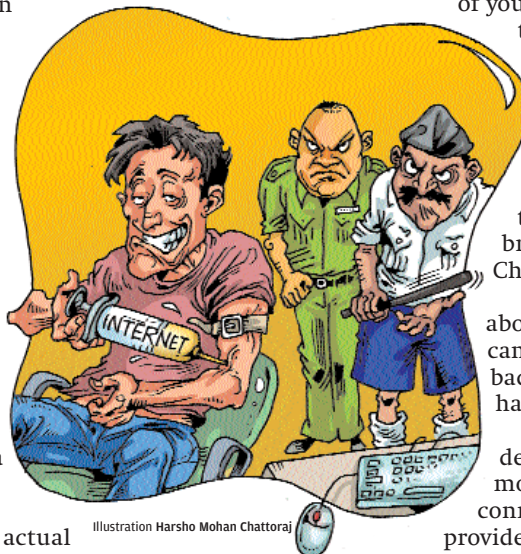


Illustration Harsho Mohan Chatteraj

number of Net-addicts grew as well—over 2 million teenagers, by some estimates, are addicted to online games, chatting and, of course, pornography.

With grades slipping, an increase in the amount of juvenile crimes, and (gasp!) anti-government sentiment coming from the capitalist-pig-controlled Net, it's no wonder that little rich Chinese boys are finding themselves being rudely awakened by Drill Sergeants at ungodly hours and being yelled at. The Internet Addiction Treatment Center (IATC) in China is where these boys

